

publishing without his permission the pictures he took of Li'l Zé. Rocket is sure that this has placed his life in danger, but from the paper's perspective, the story comes first. As it turns out, Li'l Zé is delighted by the publicity, and his battle with Knockout Ned is played out in full media glare. The newspaper staff manipulate Rocket into taking more pictures in the war zones of the City of God, and the tensions between the desire to highlight social problems to sell papers and compassion for those involved in the stories told to do so are never totally resolved.

Actors from the favela

The majority of the cast for *City of God* were not professional actors. As the director explained, at the

Breathtaking and terrifying, urgently involved with its characters, it announces a new director of great gifts and passions: Fernando Meirelles.

Remember the name.

Roger Ebert

time there simply were not enough black actors in Brazil to make this kind of movie. Two years before filming, Meirelles

set up a workshop in the favela to train a group of around 100 amateur actors. The cast of *City of God* was drawn from this pool of talent. Over the course of several months, they developed scripts through improvisation sessions. The social commitment continued after filming ended as the actors received ongoing help to build new lives for themselves. ■

Police corruption

and rampant drug dealing lead to gang wars in the City of God, where Rocket finds himself caught in the middle.

“Why return to the City of God, where God forgets about you?”

Stringy / City of God

